

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR THE POST OF
TECHNICAL OFFICER - SCERT UNDER SCHOOL EDUCATION
DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(APRIL-2025)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (60 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it.*

1. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow: (20)

Albert Schweitzer (January 14, 1875-September 4, 1965) was born into an Alsatian family which for generations had been devoted to religion, music, and education. His father and maternal grandfather were ministers; both of his grandfathers were talented organists; many of his relatives were persons of scholarly attainments.

Schweitzer entered into his intensive theological studies in 1893 at the University of Strasbourg where he obtained a doctorate in philosophy in 1899, with a dissertation on the religious philosophy of Kant, and received his licentiate in theology in 1900. He began preaching at St. Nicholas Church in Strasbourg in 1899; he served in various high ranking administrative posts from 1901 to 1912 in the Theological College of St. Thomas, the college he had attended at the University of Strasbourg. In 1906 he published *The Quest of the Historical Jesus*, a book on which much of his fame as a theological scholar rests.

Meanwhile he continued with a distinguished musical career initiated at an early age with piano and organ lessons. Only nine when he first performed in his father's church, he was, from his young manhood to his middle eighties, recognized as a concert organist, internationally known. From his professional engagements he earned funds for his education, particularly his later medical schooling, and for his African hospital. Musicologist as well as performer, Schweitzer wrote a biography of Bach in 1905 in French, published a book on organ building and playing in 1906, and rewrote the Bach book in German in 1908.

Having decided to go to Africa as a medical missionary rather than as a pastor, Schweitzer in 1905 began the study of medicine at the University of Strasbourg. In 1913, having obtained his M.D. degree, he founded his hospital at Lambaréné in French Equatorial Africa, but in 1917 he and his wife were sent to a French internment camp as prisoners of war. Released in 1918, Schweitzer spent the next six years in Europe, preaching in his old church, giving lectures and concerts, taking medical courses, writing *On the Edge of the Primeval Forest*, *The Decay and Restoration of Civilization*, *Civilization and Ethics*, and *Christianity and the Religions of the World*.

Schweitzer returned to Lambaréné in 1924 and except for relatively short periods of time, spent the remainder of his life there. With the funds earned from his own royalties and personal appearance fees and with those donated from all parts of the world, he expanded the hospital to seventy buildings which by the early 1960's could take care of over 500 patients in residence at any one time.

At Lambaréné, Schweitzer was doctor and surgeon in the hospital, pastor of a congregation, administrator of a village, superintendent of buildings and grounds, writer of scholarly books, commentator on contemporary history, musician, host to countless visitors. The honors he received were numerous, including the Goethe Prize of Frankfurt and honorary doctorates from many universities emphasizing one or another of his achievements. The Nobel Peace Prize for 1952, having been withheld in that year, was given to him on December 10, 1953. With the \$33,000 prize money, he started the leprosarium at Lambaréné. Albert Schweitzer died on September 4, 1965, and was buried at Lambaréné.

- (a) Give the meanings of the following words as used in the passage:
- (i) Intensive (2)
 - (ii) Initiated (2)
 - (iii) Engagements (2)
 - (iv) Internment (2)
 - (v) Congregation (2)
- (b) What were some of the achievements of Schweitzer? (2)
- (c) Briefly describe Schweitzer's activities in Africa. (2)
- (d) What would you classify Schweitzer's primary occupation as? Give reasons for your answer. (2)
- (e) What enabled Schweitzer to expand the hospital buildings at Lambaréné? (2)
- (f) Suggest a suitable title for the passage. (2)

2. Write a precis of the following passage in about one-thirds of its original length: (20)

The capture of animals in the wild can deplete native populations by up to 70%, according to the EcoHealth Alliance, and threaten biodiversity. Crude and non-species-specific methods may be used to catch wild animals, which can damage the ecosystem and result in injuries or death for both target and non-target animals. A study in 2013 under the United Nations Environment Programme in West and Central Africa estimated that for every chimpanzee kept as a pet or in a zoo, another ten die in capture or trade conditions.

Even if they survive the journey to Europe, the animals' suffering is far from over. They are often kept by people who don't know how to care for them, or in conditions that don't correspond to their physiological and ethological needs. A study published in 2019 demonstrated that snakes need space to stretch their bodies to their full natural length, but in fact they are commonly kept in small vivaria and racking systems that don't allow them to do this.

Problems also arise when social animals are kept in isolation, or solitary animals are kept with others. Species such as African grey parrots can pluck out their own feathers due to boredom and a lack of opportunity to socialize with other parrots. Sugar gliders are also very social animals, and can self-mutilate when kept alone. On the other hand, solitary animals such as big cats, when kept together, can pose a serious threat to each other.

Some animals die as a result of their owners' inability to take care of them. An owner might lose commitment to an animal due to traits such as its long life expectancy, large size, complex housing needs, aggressive nature or high cost. Eurogroup for Animals' member organisation AAP Animal Advocacy and Protection reported that in 2015, three-quarters of the animals they rescued had been abandoned.

3. Write an essay of about **500** words on **any one** of the following topics: (20)

- Mizoram state government's decision to completely ban the lighting of fireworks on New Year's Eve, 2025.
- Write an essay beginning with the words: "If I were the Education Minister of Mizoram ..."
- My favourite book.

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice questions) (40 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 2 each. Attempt all questions.

*This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question No. 1 - 20) Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

(2×20=40)

1. A word used to describe a person who tends to see the worst aspect of things is-
(a) Pathologist (b) Optimist
(c) Pessimist (d) Ophthalmologist
2. A person who is capable of using either hand efficiently is-
(a) Amphibious (b) Ambidextrous
(c) Leftist (d) Ambivalent
3. "Thespian" is another word for-
(a) Athlete (b) Singer
(c) Actor (d) Musician
4. A person who donates time, money, experience, skills, or talent to help create a better world is-
(a) Misanthropist (b) Philanthropist
(c) Anthropologist (d) Philologist
5. A person who can speak many languages is referred to as-
(a) Polyglot (b) Polytheist
(c) Poltergeist (d) Polymath
6. The road to ruin is paved _____ noble intentions.
(a) on (b) against
(c) with (d) of
7. The construction of the sports stadium is scheduled to be completed _____ September.
(a) in (b) On
(c) at (d) Of
8. The gifts are meant to be divided _____ the school children.
(a) among (b) between
(c) within (d) over
9. His friends all congratulated him _____ his new job.
(a) on (b) for
(c) in (d) about
10. This flight goes to New Delhi _____ Kolkata.
(a) by (b) through
(c) via (d) on

11. The best education is not necessarily obtained _____ a university.
(a) in (b) at
(c) on (d) through
12. The two friends look forward _____ meeting each other at the weekend.
(a) for (b) about
(c) at (d) to
13. We have known their family _____ many years.
(a) for (b) since
(c) in (d) by
14. There is a high demand for trained nurses in the medical _____.
(a) department (b) section
(c) profession (d) occupation
15. The harsh winter sunlight affects the _____ of drivers.
(a) vision (b) sights
(c) scene (d) seeing
16. The mother told her child not to _____ at people since it was considered rude to do so.
(a) observe (b) glance
(c) stare (d) look
17. The news channels provided _____ coverage of the war between the two countries.
(a) extensive (b) large
(c) huge (d) big
18. Violent video games can exert a bad _____ on children.
(a) power (b) control
(c) effect (d) influence
19. The seamstress had been ordered to _____ the princess a new dress.
(a) sew (b) sewn
(c) saw (d) sawn
20. Most countries are facing a _____ rate of inflation these days.
(a) big (b) tall
(c) high (d) great

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